

DD254 Tool Assessment and Recommendations

Released improvements and proposed product enhancements

Prepared for Darin Adams | 6 September 2026 | Baseline v1.10.0 / Tool v2.122

Recommended direction

Keep the single-file, offline drafting model with working data stored in the browser. The September release addressed saved-work and release-verification risks. Proposed workflow improvements remain browser-only. Potential Docker and Kubernetes hosting is a separate future delivery phase.

This report separates the 13 corrections already released from five proposed enhancements. The companion Product Requirements Document defines the proposed behavior, acceptance criteria and rollout controls. The proposals have not been implemented by this document task.

What is already delivered

The recorded production delivery is v1.10.0, internal Tool v2.122. Release records report 957 passing regression assertions and zero failures, real Chrome checks of both builds, actual JSON backup downloads, and a served demo matching the tested artifact. These are the recorded release results, not a new regression run for this report. [S1, S5, S6]

Status	Scope
Released	13 fixes covering notes, backup custody, recovery, release integrity and documentation.
Proposed	Five extensions to existing workflows, with policy qualification first.
Preserved	Offline operation, official form export, approval holds and separate issuance audiences.

Confidence and decision standard

The original 98-99% confidence estimates express engineering judgment that the owner would want each demonstrated correction. They are not statistical measurements. The broader enhancements below are reasoned recommendations; their interface and workload assumptions need a small pilot before release. [S1]

[Open the production demonstration](#)

Released Improvements

Work preservation and accurate user guidance

These six corrections are included in v1.10.0. The evidence and original confidence estimates are retained from the release assessment. [S1]

ID	Correction	Result	Confidence
01	Rapid notes on different cards	Retains queued values for each record and flushes them together.	99%
02	Pending edits in Full Backup	Captures form, template and note edits before reading the stores.	99%
03	Backup reminder after a snapshot	Keeps the reminder for edits made after the downloaded snapshot.	99%
04	Failed individual database write	Retains the newest in-tab draft and includes the emergency copy in backup.	99%
05	Unreadable portfolio database	Refuses the backup instead of reporting an empty portfolio as success.	99%
06	Classification help	Distinguishes this tool's processing limit from what the official form permits.	99%

Why this group came first

A drafting tool must preserve the newest work and accurately describe what was saved. The first five corrections address paths where the display, browser storage and downloaded backup could disagree. The sixth corrects an overbroad statement about the official form while retaining the software's handling restriction.

Practical upgrade step

When moving between downloaded filenames or browser origins, make a Full Backup from the old version, restore it in the new one and verify the records. Browser storage does not silently migrate between those locations. A saved file should be verified before the old working copy is retired. [S1]

Release Integrity and Documentation

The remaining seven shipped corrections

ID	Correction	Result	Confidence
07	Reproducible demonstration	Uses a tracked demo seed and verifies exact parity with the official build.	99%
08	Release version selection	Recognizes semantic release numbers when selecting the current build.	99%
09	Test evidence for the shipped file	Binds the regression log to the tested HTML SHA-256.	99%
10	Reliable regression execution	Bounds asynchronous waits, identifies timeouts and pins dependencies.	98%
11	Provenance and download links	Corrects flat-form provenance and links to the source release repository.	99%
12	Release bytes across platforms	Protects HTML and PDF bytes from line-ending conversion.	99%
13	Documentation and inventory	Updates the manual, security facts, build facts and maintainer/release guidance.	99%

Documents updated with the release

The user manual, security fact sheet, build facts, changelog, setup and release instructions, verification guidance and document inventory were updated together. Earlier release files were retained. The training deck and policy register are separate draft deliverables. [S1, S4, S5]

Traceable release record

Source commit: a8cc40b49bdf669e36a2d6a4a16f555e60dbe1fc. Production commit: 8a2b2d1d1880758b415279e72670702a09355686. The delivery record also reports verified GitHub artifact attestations. These identifiers describe the September release; this report does not publish another build.

[Review the v1.10.0 release](#)

[Review the recorded verification workflow](#)

Proposed Enhancements

Extend the existing workflow with evidence and accountable decisions

The baseline already provides source notes and embedded files, nonblocking advisers, approval holds with a recorded basis, revision comparison, separate distribution audiences and a Contracting Officer Package. The proposals extend those capabilities rather than counting them again as new features. [S2, S4]

ID	Order	Proposed capability	Specific addition
R01	First	Qualify policy guidance and record applicability	Correct broad retention wording; add source edition, locator and scope to affected guidance.
R02	Next	Reconcile the contract and its DD254 package	Track the contract attachment identifier, revision, guidance versions and delivery evidence.
R03	Next	Track policy questions through a recorded decision	Extend source logs and holds with linked issues, accountable reviewers and resolution history.
R04	Next	Connect requirements to inspection and cost review	Record the requirement, authority, implementation owner, oversight scope and cost assumptions.
R05	Later	Review changes and closeout by affected obligation	Extend revision comparison with impact review and disposition evidence.

The first concrete policy defect

General help around Items 3 and 5 describes post-contract retention too broadly and says Final is only for retention beyond two years. The SAP panel separately addresses a Final at closeout. The wording needs one qualified, consistent explanation across help, templates and the CO package. [S3]

32 CFR 117.13(d)(5) distinguishes return of government-provided or deliverable information from conditional retention of copies. DoDM 5205.07 section 10.5 adds SAP authorization and closeout requirements. This supports correcting the explanatory text; it does not support an automatic material-disposition or classification decision. [S7, S8]

R01 should also ensure existing contracts keep their recorded clause basis during the FAR/RFO transition. Selecting a newer source must not silently rewrite an executed contract. [S9]

Delivery Sequence and Evidence

Implement in reviewable increments

Sequence

First, reconcile policy wording and add targeted scenarios for ordinary completion, continued SAP requirements and unknown applicability. Next, add contract-package reconciliation and issue tracking together so questions link to the exact attachment or source. Then add requirement ownership, inspection scope and cost review. Expand change and closeout review after those records exist.

Release conditions

Preserve old records, authority distinctions and existing approval holds. Validate backup and restore, official PDF output, audience isolation and revision history. Bind test results to the candidate HTML, reproduce the demo and verify the published artifact. A proposed feature is complete only when its documentation and negative-path tests are included.

Scope boundaries

The tool remains a drafting aid. It does not decide classification, approve a contract change, confer access or automatically determine which agency has oversight. Local records of an approval or receipt are user-entered evidence, not authenticated Government decisions. No automatic sending, remote storage or telemetry is proposed.

Potential hosted phase

The revised PRD separates Phase A, one self-contained HTML file with browser storage, from a potential Phase B using Docker and Kubernetes to serve that same application over HTTPS. User-controlled JSON backups and PDF exports remain portable outputs. No backend database or shared-storage requirement is introduced for the current tool.

The first hosted design also keeps DD254 working records in the browser. Shared accounts, central record storage and synchronization would require a further product decision. Hosting migration uses explicit backup and restore because a new browser origin does not inherit prior records.

Sources and Supporting Records

Repository evidence and official policy references

[S1 Release assessment and confidence estimates](#)

The 13 shipped corrections and their original engineering estimates.

[S2 Application baseline and source log](#)

Source log, embedded attachments and their separate export; VLOG record schema at line 3916.

[S3 Application lifecycle guidance](#)

General Final and retention help; compare the SAP guidance at line 1023.

[S4 Change history and existing workflow](#)

v188 advisories; v190 CO package; v195 issuance, custody and revision safeguards; v1.10.0 corrections.

[S5 Released v1.10.0 artifacts](#)

Downloadable software and release documentation.

[S6 Recorded release verification](#)

Public workflow for the released source commit; 957 regression assertions passed.

[S7 32 CFR 117.13](#)

Paragraphs (d) and (e): classification guidance, completion and challenges. Rechecked 6 September 2026.

[S8 DoDM 5205.07 dated 17 January 2025](#)

Section 10.5: SAP disposition and closeout. Rechecked 6 September 2026.

[S9 DoD Class Deviation 2026 O0025](#)

RFO Part 40 adoption and attached coverage. Rechecked 6 September 2026; applicability still depends on the acquisition and contract.

[S10 Official DD Form 254 instructions](#)

Items 13 through 15 and form completion guidance. Source used in the existing lifecycle training.